ments an index holds, deleted documents, merge and flush statistics, and more. In the next couple of sections, we review APIs to fetch these statistics.

6.7.1 Index statistics

Every index generates statistics such as the total number of documents it has, a count of documents deleted, the shard's memory, get and search request data, and so on. The `_stats` API helps us retrieve index statistics for both primary and replica shards.

The following listing shows the mechanism to fetch statistics for a `cars` index by invoking the `_stats` endpoint. Figure 6.7 shows the statistics returned by this call.

Listing 6.36 Fetching the statistics of an index

```
GET cars/_stats
```

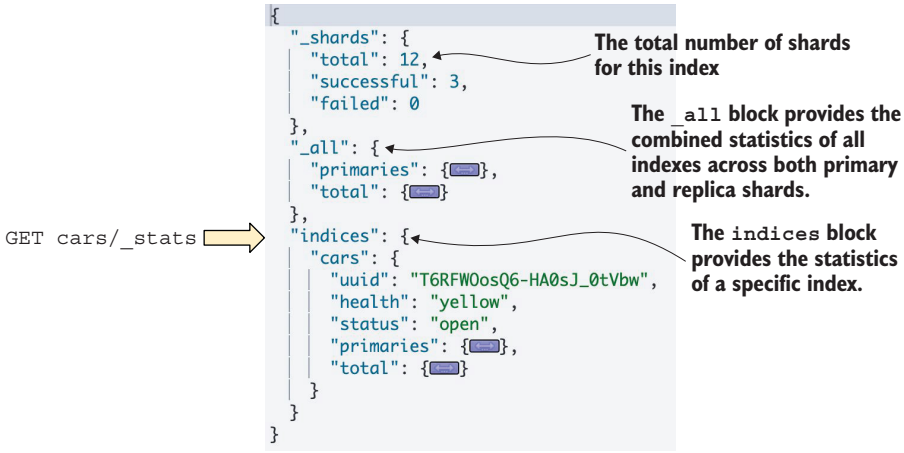


Figure 6.7 Statistics for a `cars` index

The response includes a `total` attribute, which is the total number of shards (primary and replica) associated with this index. As we have only one primary shard, the `successful` attribute points to this shard count.

The response consists of two blocks:

- The `_all` block, with the aggregated statistics for all indexes combined
- The `indices` block, with statistics for individual indexes (each index in that cluster)

These blocks consist of two buckets of statistics: the `primaries` bucket contains statistics related to just the primary shards, while the `total` bucket indicates statistics for both primary and replica shards. Elasticsearch returns over a dozen statistics (see